Media Policy

The Green Party will support an independent media and enable community-based media. We will support publicly owned broadcasting services and fund locally produced content, prioritising those communities that are not well served by commercial interests, including Māori and children.

Vision

A strong, diverse and independent media contributes to the maintenance of effective democracy, and to our social, cultural, economic and environmental wellbeing.

Values and Principles

Decisions relating to broadcasting and media must uphold the following values and principles:

- *Honour Te Tiriti o Waitangi*: Māori media should be prioritised and recognised as a platform to uphold the culture of tangata whenua in Aotearoa New Zealand.
- *Ecological Wisdom*: The environmental impact of the production and storage of media content should be minimised.
- *Social Responsibility*: The media should be accessible to people of all abilities, and used to inform, educate and entertain in a manner that supports citizens to participate effectively in democracy and appreciate each others' needs, interests and aspirations.
- *Appropriate Decision-Making*: The right to broadcast or publish is balanced with expectations to act in a responsible and inclusive manner.
- *Non-Violence*: Non-violent resolution of political and social conflict is based on the knowledge, acceptance and understanding of diverse communities, and of their needs, interests and aspirations. Media should act as a means of checks and balances against the misuse or abuse of social, economic and political power.
- *Independence:* A vigorous, independent and diverse media is the cornerstone of a free society: Public broadcasting and community-based media initiatives should be supported; and directives by the state, or ownership and control by international media conglomerates, or domination by local commercial monopolies should be avoided.

Strategic Priorities

The Green Party's strategic goals include:

> *"As a Party we want to see Te Ao Māori and Te Reo Māori flourish in Aotearoa.*
>
> *"All people will be empowered to shape the systems that affect them."*

Actions in this policy that will help achieve this include:

- Establish, monitor and enforce obligations attached to the right to broadcast and stream content online, including honouring the rights and interests of tangata whenua under Te Tiriti o Waitangi. (1.1)
- Support quality public service broadcasting and streaming, and digital media commons, that nurture and promote our own talent and creativity as a nation, reflecting the unique social and cultural diversity of Aotearoa New Zealand. (1.3)
- Protect the political independence and public ownership of Radio New Zealand, Television New Zealand and the Māori Television Service and iwi radio. (1.3.2)
- Secure long term funding and support for dedicated Māori language media, including the Māori Television Service and iwi radio stations, to be independent, secure and successfully play a major role in revitalising language and culture. (2.4.2)

Connected Policies

A freely available and politically independent media makes a significant contribution to the effectiveness of Governance, Research, Science and Technology, and Education, through the provision of political debate, diverse perspectives and information about the world we live in. It is a key mechanism for celebrating the Arts, Culture and Heritage of Aotearoa New Zealand. It is increasingly entwined with the development of Digital technologies. Its Workforce must be protected.

Policy Positions

1. Free and Independent Media

Issues

Ownership of media in Aotearoa New Zealand is dominated by transnational media-communication conglomerates and private financial organisations. National media is not immune to global trends that threaten free and independent media, leading to a shift of audiences and advertising revenue from traditional mass media to social media, and the purchased influence of far-right populists. This risks undermining public knowledge and increasing the polarisation of views.

Actions

1.1. Establish, monitor and enforce obligations attached to the right to broadcast and stream content online, including honouring the rights and interests of tangata whenua under Te Tiriti o Waitangi.

1.2. Ensure responsible self-regulation of national media, by:

1.2.1. Establishing a Tiriti-based framework for responsible self-regulation, covering the Advertising Standards Authority, the Broadcasting Standards Authority and the Press Council;

1.2.2. Creating an organisational structure to monitor and report on media self-regulation organisations, and support an accessible appeals process; and

1.2.3. Issuing minimum codes or regulations in the event that self-regulation can be demonstrated to have failed.

1.3. Support quality public service broadcasting and streaming, and digital media commons, that nurture and promote our own talent and creativity as a nation, reflecting the unique social and cultural diversity of Aotearoa New Zealand, including by:

1.3.1. Ring-fencing public revenue, including for New Zealand on Air, and facilitating additional sources of revenue, to ensure sustainable funding for public broadcasting and streaming;

1.3.2. Protecting the political independence and public ownership of Radio New Zealand, Television New Zealand and the Māori Television Service and iwi radio;

1.3.3. Establishing a Digital Media Commons that, in partnership with public television, public radio, community broadcasters, and website media providers, provides access to public-interest content and publicly funded resources (such as the Public Archives, museums and libraries); and

1.3.4. Resourcing all national media to support Māori language and culture, offer Te Reo Māori services, and use correct pronunciation for Māori words and place names.

2. Inclusive and accessible media

Issues

New Zealanders are heavily exposed to commercial and imported content. By comparison, locally made content that shows Aotearoa New Zealand's cultures, languages and values is relatively limited. This reduces opportunities for children to see themselves and their communities, and Māori as tangata whenua, positively reflected on screen. It is hard for Māori to exercise rangatiratanga and be heard in the media. Expressions of the indigenous culture of Aotearoa New Zealand, which is the birthright of every Māori, and the heritage of every New Zealander, are diluted. Access gaps for disabled people and speakers of minority languages, for example, can deepen social exclusion and limit participation as audience or creator. Meanwhile, access to harmful content has impacts on mental health, attitudes to relationships, and discrimination - especially for young people.

Actions

2.1. Ensure and incentivise the production of music, films and programmes for broadcasting and streaming by diverse Aotearoa New Zealand artists, producers, writers and directors, including by:

2.1.1. Requiring Government-funded broadcasters and streaming services to employ a workforce that reflects the communities it serves, and employ best practice for media coverage of marginalised communities;

2.1.2. Investigating minimum Aotearoa New Zealand content quotas for public broadcasters and streaming services and incentives for commercial broadcasters and streaming services to provide higher levels of local content; and

2.1.3. Increasing support for Pasifika media and services to the Pacific, such as Radio New Zealand International.

2.2. Ensure that New Zealand on Air enables local stories, songs and perspectives to reach audiences by:

2.2.1. Prioritising the local production, broadcasting and streaming of educational, interactive children's media content;

2.2.2. Permitting New Zealand on Air to require less of a financial contribution from local broadcasters when generating content in specific priority genres; and

2.2.3. Implementing criteria for New Zealand On Air funding decisions that increase the quality of content for niche audiences who are underserved by commercial programming.

2.3. Enable community broadcasting to grow and develop in a manner that reflects ethnic and cultural diversity, and changing interests, needs and aspirations, including by:

2.3.1. Providing a regulatory framework for broadcasting and streaming that offers community-based broadcasters and streaming services ongoing security over both broadcasting rights and funding; and

2.3.2. Investigating establishing a network of community media hubs to share content and contribute to the Digital Media Commons.

2.4. Support a strong voice for Māori as media content producers and broadcasters, by:

2.4.1. Reviewing funding rates to achieve full equivalence with English language media ensure Māori content producers can continue to provide varied genres of quality content;

2.4.2. Securing long term funding and support for dedicated Māori language media, including the Māori Television Service and iwi radio stations, to be independent, secure and successfully play a major role in revitalising language and culture; and

2.4.3. Working with the Māori media industry to develop and enhance services for a multimedia, multi-platform environment.

2.5. Minimise harmful media content, by:

2.5.1. Updating, monitoring and enforcing the codes of broadcasting practice on the portrayal of violence on television, and developing an appropriate equivalent for online content and social media;

2.5.2. Monitoring and regularly reporting on the amount of harmful content viewed by New Zealanders in all media formats; and

2.5.3. Incentivising media platforms to counter harmful narratives and promote diverse role models.

2.6. Enable caregivers and educators to minimise young people's exposure to harmful content, including by:

2.6.1. Investigating removing commercial advertising from broadcasts and streaming services aimed at pre-school and school-age audiences.

2.7. Ensure that media is accessible to all by:

2.7.1. Enacting legislation to require broadcasters and streaming providers to provide media in an accessible format, including captioning, audio-description and New Zealand Sign Language content; and

2.7.2. Adopting an ongoing monitoring and evaluation process, co-designed with the disabled community, around captioning standards and quality of access.